



VIMAL PALANI

Sr. VMware and Windows Administrator

CONTACT



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LinkedIn

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Information Technology | 2007

B.S. Abdur Rahman Crescent Institute of Science and Technology, Chennai, India

KEY COMPETENCIES

IT Infrastructure Administration

VMware & Windows Administration Datacenter

Consolidation, Migration Business Continuity

Plan

Datacenter / Server Virtualization

VMware & Windows Project Implementation

Team Leadership

Knowledge Sharing

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Over 18 of industry experience, including 15+ years of deep expertise in VMware virtualization. Skilled in designing, installing, configuring, and managing VMware technologies such as ESX/ESXi, vCenter Server, vSAN, vROPS, and SRM.

Currently serving as both a VMware and Windows Administrator, delivering comprehensive infrastructure support for global customers. Adept at managing Windows Server environments, performing upgrades, patching, hardening, and automation. Strong understanding of business operations, with a focus on aligning IT strategies to drive operational efficiency, service excellence, and business growth.

AREAS OF EMPHASIS

- Upgraded vCenter Servers, ESXi hosts, vROPS, SRM, and VMware Tools from version 6.x to 7.x, and from 7.x to 8.x, ensuring minimal downtime and seamless transitions.
- Led the migration of 400+ ESXi hosts, 120+ physical servers, and 2,400+ virtual machines—including management IPs—into the Cisco ACI network.
- Consolidated two datacenters by migrating virtual servers and relocating Windows physical servers to the primary site. Decommissioned legacy HP Gen8/Gen9 ESXi hosts and replaced them with HP Synergy infrastructure through a phased approach.
- Extensive hands-on experience upgrading Windows Servers across multiple versions, including migrations from Windows Server 2012 to 2016, and from 2016 to 2019/2022.
- As part of the Configuration Baseline project, deployed 150+ Level 1 security controls across all Windows servers via Group Policy Objects (GPOs).
- Migrated eligible physical servers to virtual machines on the VMware platform as part of a hardware refresh initiative, optimizing resource utilization and enhancing scalability.
- Hands-on experience in mass deployment for installation, upgrades, and uninstallation of agents such as Splunk, CrowdStrike, SCCM, Tanium, and Qualys using SCCM and Tanium.
- Performed patching for vCenter Servers, ESXi hosts, vROPS, SRM, and Windows Servers using SCCM and Tanium, ensuring up-to-date security and system stability across the environment.
- Utilized RSRS/LogicMonitor reports from vROPS to analyze workload utilization, performing scale-up and scale-down operations for virtual servers to optimize performance and resource allocation.
- Implemented SSL certificates for vCenter Server, HP OneView, and FTP Servers.
- Migrated all Windows local admin accounts from Local Administrator Password Solution (LAPS) to CyberArk. Onboarded ESXi root accounts and all service accounts used for infrastructure servers, strengthening security and centralized management.
- Partnered with the storage team to successfully migrate all virtual servers from HP 3PAR to PURE Storage, improving storage efficiency and performance.

TRAINING

VxBlock Administration and Management

VMware vCloud: Deploy and Manage the VMware Cloud [V1.5]

VMware vSphere Optimize and Scale v6

Nutanix Certified Professional - Multicloud Infrastructure v6.5

Tanium Deploy and Patch modules

CERTIFICATIONS

- Microsoft Certified Systems Administrator (MCSA)
- Implementing Microsoft Azure Infrastructure Solutions (70-533)
- VCP - VMware Certified Professional 3.5, 4.0, 5.0 & 6.0
- Windows Server 2008 R2, Server Virtualization (Hyper-V)
- Nutanix Platform Professional 4.5
- Certified in SimpliVity Implementation



COGNIZANT TECHNOLOGY SOLUTIONS INDIA PVT. LTD.

Manager - Infra Ops Specialist (Onsite – CA, USA) | Aug 2019 - Present **Cluster Manager – Windows, VMware, Hyper-V & Citrix technology** | Apr 2014 – Aug 2019

Products handled: VMware ESX / ESXi server, VMware Virtual Center, HA cluster, DRS cluster and related VMware products such as VMware converters, vROPS, SRM & Log Insight

KEY RESULT AREAS

Automation Server Builds and
Decommissioning Service
Request Management Change
Management Continuous
Improvement Risk Assessment
& Mitigation Customer
Communication Vendor
Coordination

Techno - Functional Coordination of key projects as follows:

- Large scale DC consolidation- End to end Data Centre Migration from design and virtualization through delivery
 - VMware Infrastructure Upgrade & Migration
 - Upgraded vCenter server, ESXi hosts and Virtual Machines from 5.0 to 5.5
 - Migrated VMware infrastructure to Hyper-V platform
 - Implementation of CA signed SSL certificate, Site Recovery Manager 6.x, vRealize Log Insights and vCOPS
 - VMware KT transition for APAC, Europe and US customers
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- Noted for strong leadership in team development and management. Spearheaded various initiatives including Hiring, Task Delegation, Resource Allocation, Skill Assessment, Performance Review, FTE Validation
 - Piloted Data Center Transformation and IT Infrastructure Management projects
 - Facilitated smooth communication and coordination with the client team, and efficiently supported their business functions

Currently, Leading end-to-end VMware and Windows Infrastructure implementation and support for Pacific Life Insurance Company – Newport Beach, CA (onsite)- Aug 2019 - Present

- Professionally represented the infrastructure team as VMware & Windows Onsite Lead
- Involved in Managing / Monitoring 417 ESXi hosts with more than 2500 virtual servers using vCenter Server
- Catered to doing infrastructure coordination related to design and set up activities
 - Installation and configuration of VMware update manager
 - Upgraded multiple ESXi hosts and virtual machine
 - VMware Assessment and update in RAID Log (Risks, Assumptions, Issues and Dependencies)
 - vRealize operation manager upgrade from 8.0 to 8.3 version
 - Install and manage CrowdStrike, Qualys, Splunk SCCM and Flexera
 - Veeam Backup tool implementation
 - Perform physical to virtual (P2V) and virtual to virtual (V2V) migrations using VMware converter
- Led efforts in Service Management Automation (SMA) for automatic server build and automatic server decommission
- Experience in writing basic PowerShell Scripts to automate manual tasks in VMware / Windows environment
- storage migration activity from HP 3PAR to PURE storage
- Hardware refresh project along with customer SME for migrating VMs from legacy hardware to HP Synergy
- Monitored service delivery compliance to budget, quality standards and customer requirement

As a cluster manager, Managed and Monitored more than 550+ ESXi/ESX with more than 3000+ Virtual servers worldwide | Apr 2014 – Aug 2019

- Led Installation, configuration and management of VMware ESXi 3.X, 4.X and 5.X versions and Virtual center server 3.X, 4.X and 5.X versions.

- Provided L3 & L3 + level technical support, troubleshooting and problem solving in the environment.
- Worked on Disaster Recovery projects using the VMWare SRM 4.0 & VPLEX Solution.
- Contributed greatly towards all functions of VMware Virtualization for diverse sector clients



Hewlett Packard Global Soft Pvt Ltd.

ITO Svc Delivery Cons III-b | Feb 2012 – Apr 2014

Managed and monitored 257 ESXi, Free Hypervisor and GSX hosts with 2000+ Virtual servers for AP MOLLER MAERSK, DAMCO, MAERSK SUBMARINE, MAERSK OIL Companies

- ➔ New virtual machine setup in VMware Workstations (multi-site) ➔ Server Consolidation ➔ vSphere up-gradation and Hypervisor implementation ➔ Hardware refreshes ➔ ESX /ESXi Patching Upgradation ➔ LAN refresh
- Transitions and Migrations ➔ Datastore Standardization

Key Responsibilities handled:

- Planned, designed, and developed VMware DRS, VMware HA, System Fault Tolerance, Business continuity and Disaster Recovery for Virtual Machines in Production and Non-Production in France, Bangladesh, Portugal, Sweden, Egypt, China, Slovakia and New Zealand
- Upgraded ESXi from 3.5i to VSPHERE 4.1 version
- Transition of CNSGH01 in Egypt and Dubai Sites
- Migrated disks from FATA to FC in THBKK01, Bangladesh, UAE, Netherlands, Mexico, Senegal, Nigeria & Benin
- Identified 2000 physical servers, converted them into virtual environment & upgrade the windows OS on the virtual servers at remote sites

Customer Appreciation award for ESX Upgradation in Sweden Site and Server consolidation in Egypt Site



Maersk Global Service Centre's (India) Pvt. Ltd., Chennai

Executive (IS Processes - GCC) | Sept 2010 - Jan 2012

- Customer Satisfaction award for implementing new Virtualization set up in Bangladesh and Portugal site



HCL Technologies, Chennai

System Specialist | Oct 2008 – Aug 2010

- Piloted projects as a VMware Administrator, managing more than 25 ESX Hosts and 535 + VMware in various US locations | Managed migration of Virtual Center Server from 2.5 to 4.0. | Best Performance award

Lason India Private Ltd., Chennai

Technologist of IT | Apr 2007 - Oct 2008

CSC (Computer Education Private Limited), Chennai

System Administrator | July 2005 – April 2007

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Hardware

DELL, HP, IBM, LENOVO, FUJITSU and CISCO UCS

Operating System **ESX 4.0, ESXi 3.x, 4.x, 5.x & 6.x, Windows Server 2003/2008/2012/2016/2019, Linux and Solaris**

Programming Languages **PowerCLI & PowerShell**

Cloud Computing **Microsoft Azure**

ADDITIONAL INFORMATION